



Crossing borders: a strategic assessment of Cashew's APAC expansion options

Fintech Consulting Project

The Nutcrackers

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Your team today



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Agenda

01.

Company overview

02.

Market selection rationale

03.

Deep dive on the three main markets

04.

Market comparison & entry strategy

05.

Go-to-market strategy

06.

Appendix

Executive summary

Problem	Cashew needs to scale from Singapore's mature market (16 partner banks, 500+ packages, 1–3 day AIP), but lacks a clear, low-risk international expansion roadmap
Market	Three priority markets (Hong Kong, Australia, South Korea) offer scale and digital infrastructure, but Hong Kong is the best immediate fit • Hong Kong: \$3.02Tn market, HKMA fintech-forward, English-speaking, cultural fit • Australia: \$6.58Tn, but late mover vs Lendi/Athena (10-year head start) • South Korea: \$12.1Tn, but government mortgage suppression + KakaoBank incumbent risk
Causes of expansion risk	Three misalignment layers create expansion risk • Regulatory complexity (eg. Australia needs ASIC/AUSTRAC; weak API in Vietnam/Indonesia) • Competitive gap (eg. KakaoBank, Lendi have multi-year first-mover advantage) • Operational friction (Direct FDI in HK requires HKMA authorization from scratch– long & costly)
Cost-effective entry strategy	For Hong Kong: international strategic alliance (with AQUMON) – zero upfront capital, performance-only fee • AQUMON refers its mass-affluent wealth clients to Cashew's mortgage platform via embedded referral • Cashew provides mortgage advisory and closes the deal: bank pays AQUMON, AQUMON pays Cashew a referral fee • Easy to exit or upgrade to JV as HK traction builds
Revenue growth roadmap	Partner-led, phased rollout in Hong Kong • 0-6 months: Strategic alliance with AQUMON (warm access to 150+ bank decision-makers, HKMA credibility) • 6-18 months: Deeper integration, target AQUMON's mass-affluent clients • 18-36 months: Add real estate agency channels • Decentralised execution + customised platform (adapt mortgage rules/UX for HK, not copy Singapore)

Cashew's AI-first platform has captured 100% of Singapore's bank market and its model is built to travel

Company overview

Cashew in a nutshell

Mission: “Reinvent the mortgage process – make home financing simple, transparent, and stress-free for every Singapore homeowner.”

500+

Loan packages compared

16

Partner banks (100% SG market)

1–3 days

AIP turnaround time

SGD 230Bn

SG housing loans outstanding

B2C

Cashew.sg

Consumer marketplace
Homeowners self-serve to compare rates, get AI guidance, and apply online with human advisor backup

B2B

ACCESS app

Property-agent platform
Agents check live rates, submit client applications end-to-end, and earn referral commissions

What makes Cashew different



AI + human hybrid

AI-matching of 500+ packages and a 24/7 chat assistant, paired with human advisors for the final mile



End-to-end digital

MyInfo pre-fill, e-signature, and digital document verification → no branch visits, no paperwork stacks



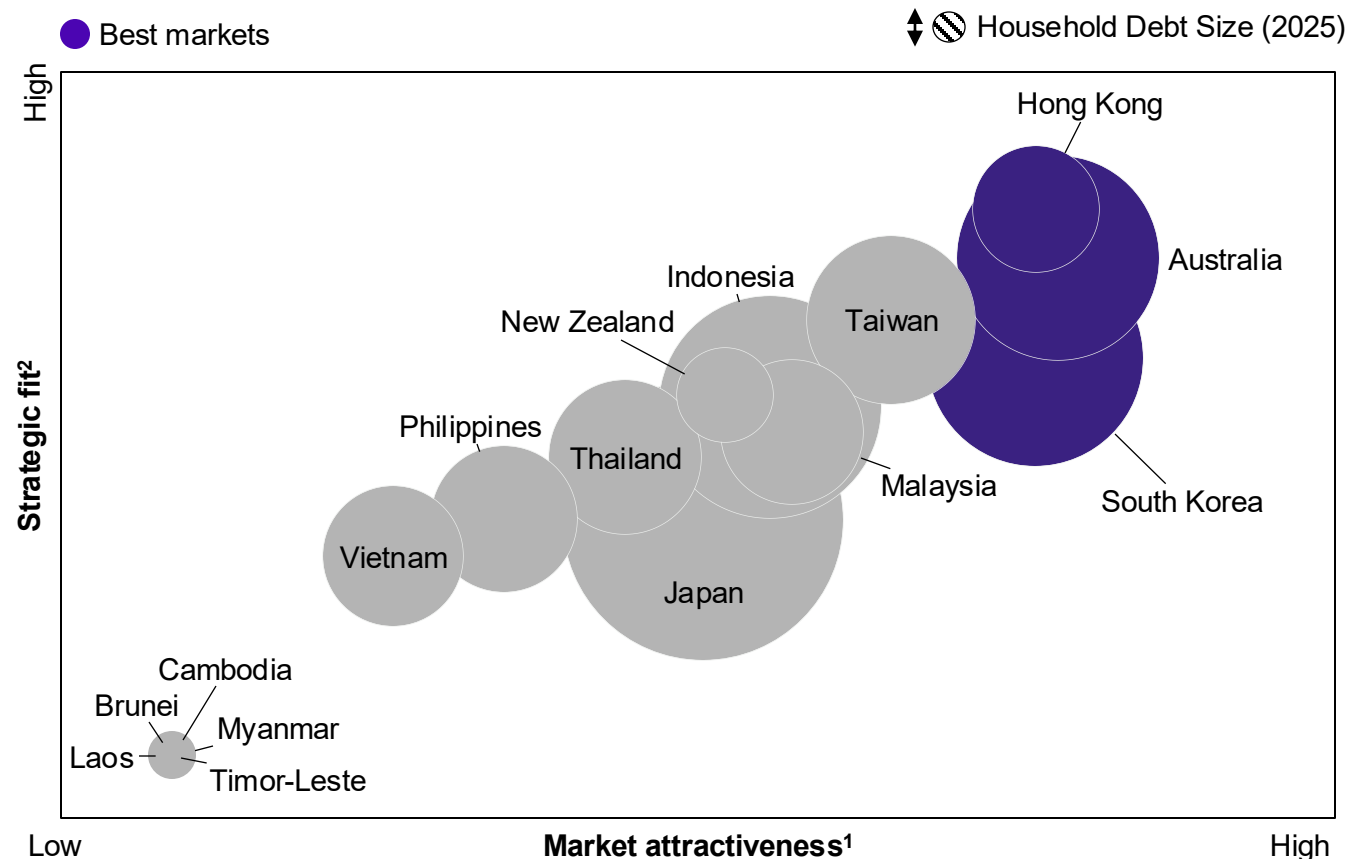
Best rate guarantee

Find a better publicly available rate within 14 days of approval and Cashew pays the difference in cash

Three markets clear the bar: Hong Kong, Australia, and South Korea combine scale, digital readiness, and strategic fit

Market selection

Market selection portfolio



Key insights

Why these 3 markets were selected

- **Scale and demand:** they have attractive mortgage and RE markets.
- **Infrastructure:** they are the most mature on bank data, open banking/API, e-KYC and credit data availability.
- **Strategic fit:** Hong Kong has a strong cultural fit and partnership potential. Australia can serve as scaling blueprint in a mature market. South Korea sharpens Cashew's tech and process capabilities through a strong infrastructure fit.

Why others were eliminated

- **Weak data / API infrastructure:** Vietnam, Indonesia, Philippines, Malaysia and Thailand
- **Higher regulatory / entry complexity:** Vietnam, Philippines, Taiwan, Thailand, Malaysia and Japan
- **Low market size:** Brunei, Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar and Timor-Leste

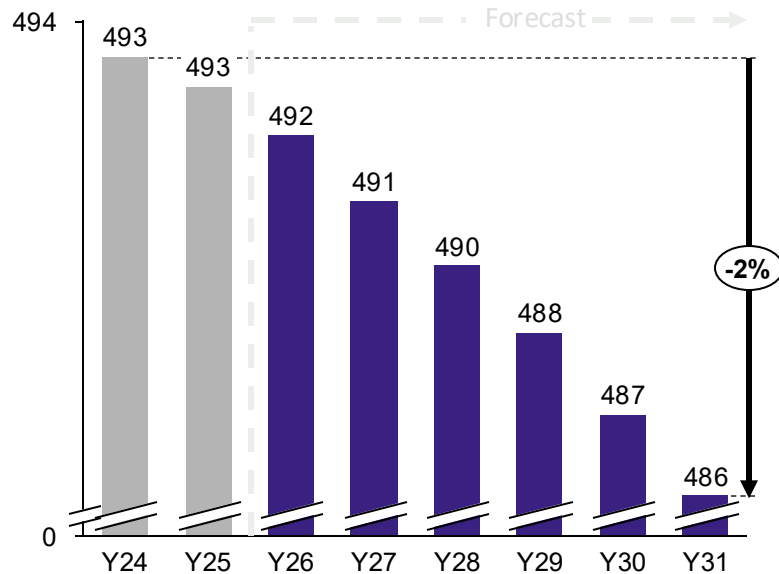
Notes: 1) Market attractiveness is measured by market size, digital adoption & fintech penetration, competitor landscape, regulatory complexity; 2) Strategic Fit is measured by alignment with Cashew's product model, ease of integration with banks/property data, language, consumer behavior, cultural affinity; 3) Full explanation of the methodology used for the market selection in Appendix (slide 20)

South Korea is a \$12Tn digital powerhouse, but government tightening makes it a watch-and-wait market

Deep dive – South Korea

Residential real estate transactions

Unit sales (in thousand units)



- **Volumes remain broadly flat**, with a slight decline by 2031.
- **Negative CAGR.**
- **A mature market**, with no meaningful structural growth over the period.

Market metrics

\$8.1Tn Residential real estate market

91.7% Debt-to-GDP ratio

82% Digital adoption mobile banking

\$1,776 Bn Household debt

Key dimensions



Strategic fit

Strong digital fit but full platform recalibration needed.



Business model fit

No multi-bank comparison platform exists today, direct product gap.



Regulatory environment

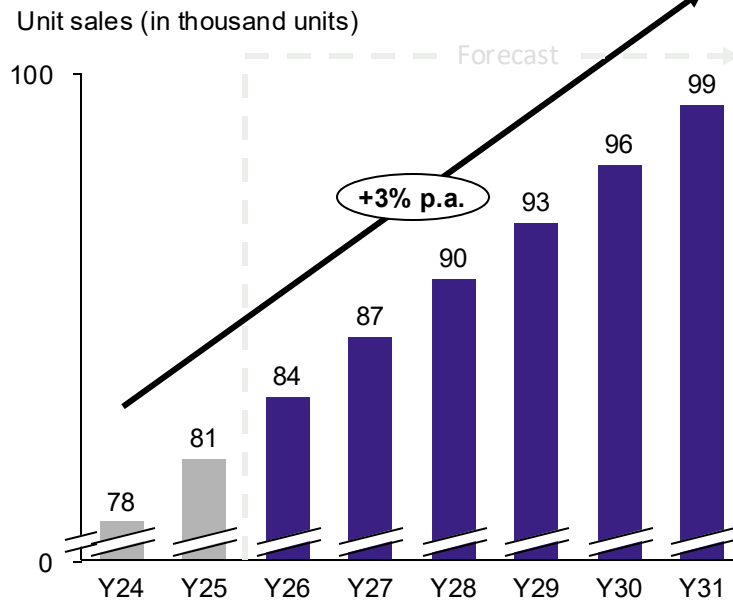
Three consecutive rounds of mortgage tightening since 2024 cap the addressable market growth.

Sources: Bank of Korea (2025) · coinlaw.io Mobile Banking Statistics (2025) · DataReportal Digital South Korea (2025) · FSC Housing Loan Measures (Oct 2025) · FSC Stressed DSR Phase 2 (Sep 2024) · FSC Stressed DSR Phase 3 (Jul 2025) · IMF Korea Article IV (2025) · KakaoBank 4Q2024 Earnings (Feb 2025) · Korea Herald (Oct 2025) · Statista Residential Real Estate South Korea (2025)

Australia's \$6.6Tn market is attractive, but a three-layer licensing burden makes direct entry premature

Deep dive – Australia

Residential real estate transactions



- **Unit sales show a steady upward trend**, rising from 76k to 99k by 2031.
- **+3% p.a. growth** indicates a healthy and expanding transaction market.

Market metrics

\$6.58 Tn Residential real estate market

120.3% Debt-to-GDP ratio

69% Digital adoption online banking

\$2,269 Bn Household debt

Key dimensions



Strategic fit

Compatible fit but Cashew enters as a late mover against incumbents with a 10-year head start.



Business model fit

CDR open banking is the most advanced infrastructure in APAC but Lendi, Athena and Tiimely already occupy the same space.



Regulatory environment

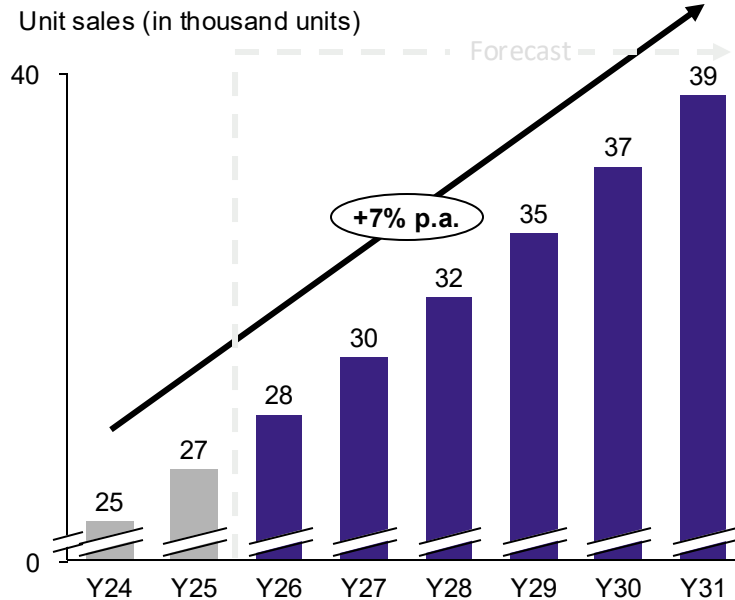
Most complex entry in the shortlist, ASIC licensing, AUSTRAC registration and CDR accreditation required before launch.

Sources: ACCC CDR Rules (2024) · APRA Monthly ADI Statistics (Oct 2025) · ASIC NCCP Act 2009 · AUSTRAC AML/CTF Act 2006 · CEIC Data — Australia Household Debt % of GDP (2025) · IBISWorld Mortgage Brokers Australia (2025) · Lendi Group corporate disclosure · MFAA Industry Intelligence Service Q2 2025 · Statista Residential Real Estate Australia (2026)

Hong Kong combines a \$3Tn credit-rich market, a fintech-forward regulator, and no dominant digital broker

Deep dive – Hong Kong

Residential real estate transactions



- **Volumes stay broadly stable**, supporting a predictable and resilient market base.
- **A mature market with steady demand**, ideal for a focused entry strategy.

Market metrics

\$3.02 Tn Residential real estate market

87.6% Debt-to-GDP

51.85% Digital adoption online banking

\$374 Bn Household debt

Key dimensions



Strategic fit

Hong Kong is the best-fit market, with a large English-speaking base, cultural similarity to Singapore, and small incumbent risk.



Business model fit

Cashew's model maps directly onto HK's broker market with no structural adaptation required beyond HIBOR integration.



Regulatory environment

HKMA is the most fintech-forward regulator in APAC: mortgage referral registration achievable within months.

Sources: CEIC Data — Hong Kong Household Debt % of GDP (2025) · HKMA Fintech Supervisory Sandbox Guidelines (2024) · HKMA Mortgages (2025) · IMF Article IV Hong Kong (2025) · JP Morgan Private Bank — The Case for Hong Kong Real Estate (March 2026) · mReferral corporate disclosure · Statista Residential Real Estate Hong Kong (2026) · Worldometers — Hong Kong GDP per Capita (2025)

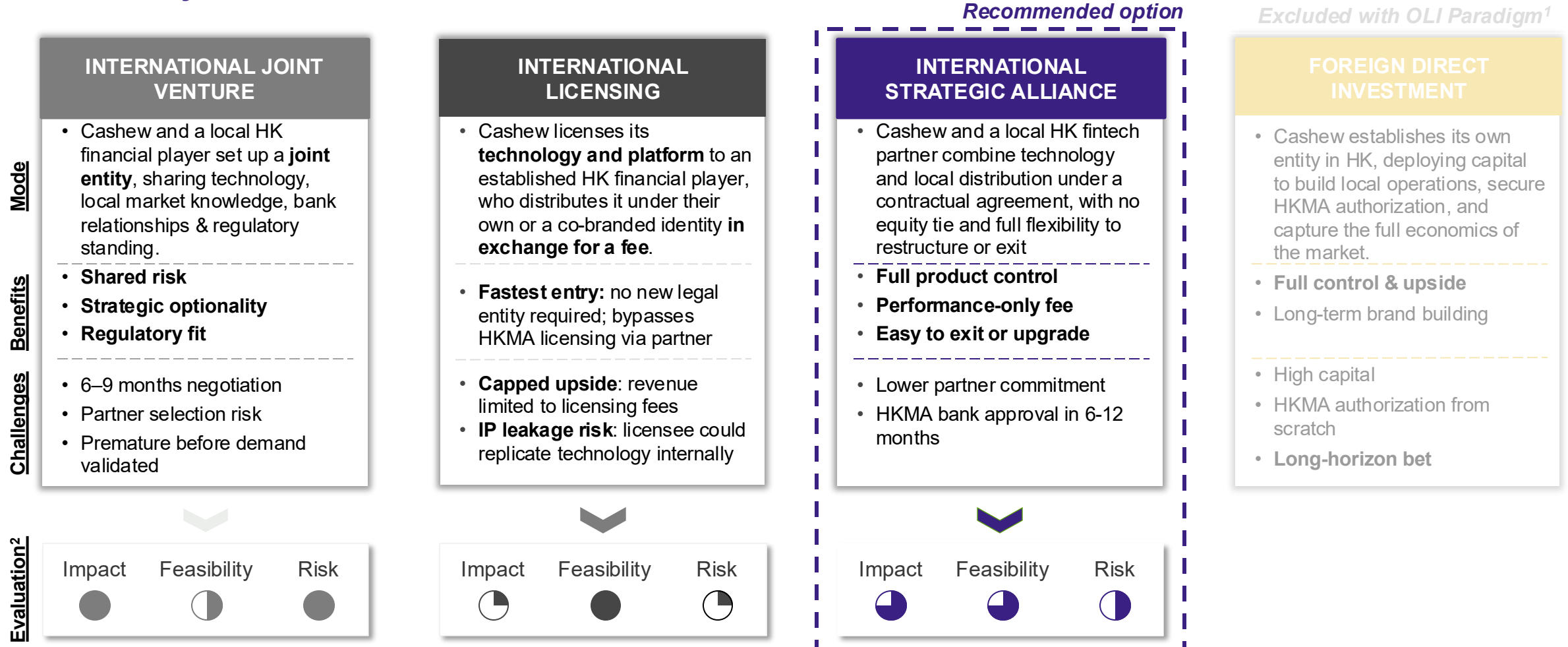
Hong Kong emerges as Cashew's priority market, while Australia and South Korea offer staged entry opportunities

Market comparison

	SOUTH KOREA	AUSTRALIA	<i>Recommended option</i> HONG KONG
 OPPORTUNITIES	- Massive market, real estate market valued at \$12.1 - Digital readiness: internet penetration 97.4% and 82% of adults use mobile banking.	Second largest loan market in APAC - English-speaking, high digital adoption 4.04% expected real estate growth rate	- High-quality and stable market (Top in the region) Highly developed credit market - Efficient and concentrated market structure
 RISKS	- Government actively suppressing mortgage growth Strong competitor KakaoBank creates incumbent risk - The Jeonse system reduces the addressable market	- Saturated market Highly regulated - Geographic complexity: large country, fragmented state-by-state regulation	Bank-dominated market structure - Regulatory and compliance requirements
 MARKET ENTRY STRATEGY	Strategic alliance No capital commitment now, build local partnerships and monitor regulatory environment. - Re-evaluate in 18–24 months.	Strategic white-label licensing Monetize technology asset without frontal competition – license to mid-tier broker network, - convert to FDI in 2–3 years.	International strategic alliance - Partner with a HK SFC-licensed fintech, embeds Cashew into its client base for pre-qualified leads, regulatory cover and capital-light entry Optimal risk/return profile.

A strategic alliance is the optimal entry mode for Cashew, unlocking distribution at limited risk

Market entry mode



AQUMON unlocks Cashew's target segment from day one, pre-qualified mass-affluent clients, and zero upfront capital

Go-to-market strategy – partner selection



is Hong Kong's leading WealthTech company, founded in 2016. It was the first independent robo-advisor to be accredited by the SFC in 2017 and has since maintained a **close relationship with regulators** to advance new fintech initiatives.



AQUMON brings

- **Existing HK client base:** mass affluent investors and homeowners
- **Established trust and brand** in the HK market
- **Distribution channel** and **client relationships**



What AQUMON gains

- A mortgage product to offer existing clients, **filling a clear gap** in its wealth management offering
- A **new revenue stream** via referral fees at zero additional cost
- **Higher client stickiness** and **reinforced positioning** as a **full-service fintech platform**



Cashew brings

- Digital mortgage comparison **platform**
- Mortgage advisory **expertise and advisors**
- **Lead conversion** and application engine
- Bank integrations and mortgage **product knowledge**

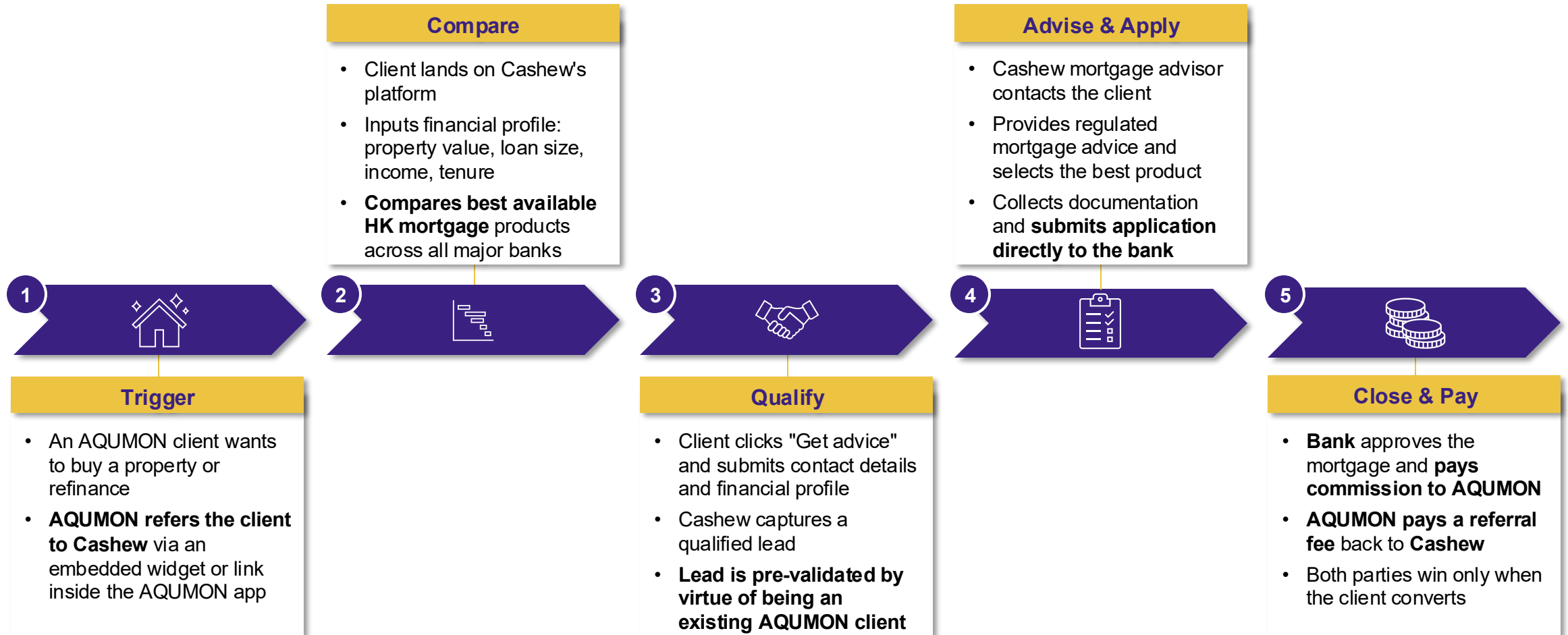


What Cashew gains

- Instant **access** to AQUMON's existing base of **mass affluent HK clients**
- Market entry with **zero regulatory burden:** no HK license required at this stage
- Pre-qualified leads with **high conversion potential**
- **Capital-light expansion:** no local entity, no office, no operational setup in HK

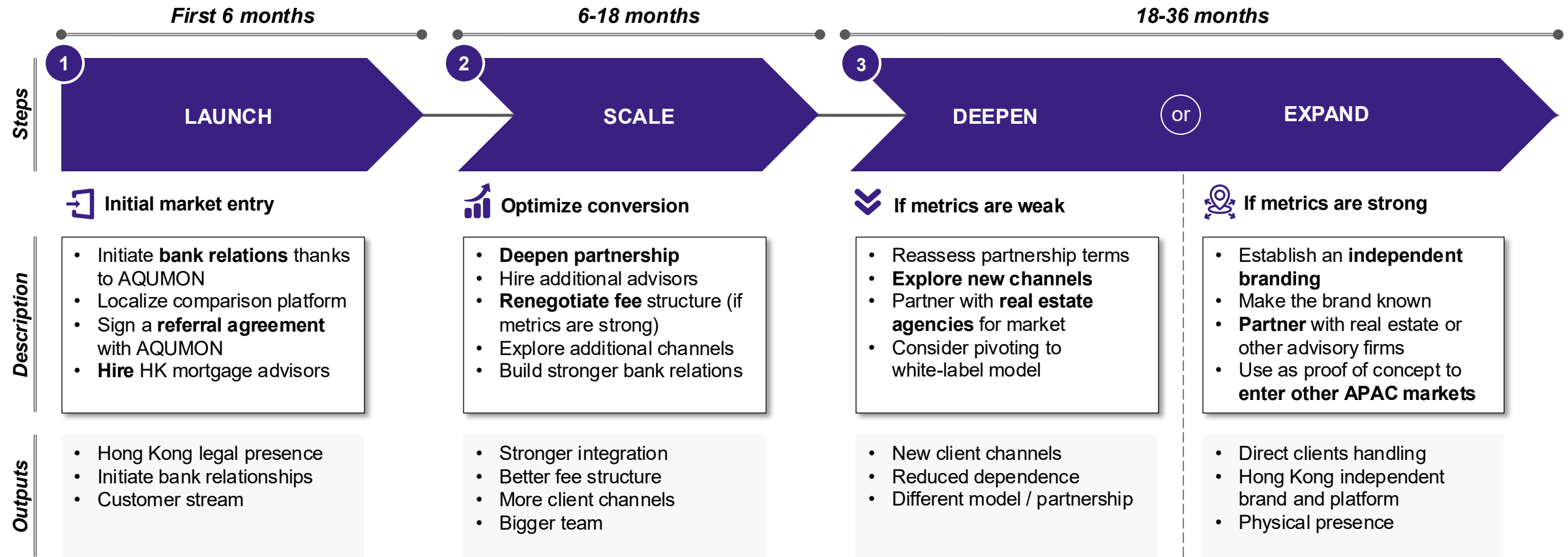
The five-step process from trigger to close is fully performance-based, Cashew earns a referral fee from AQUMON

Go-to-market strategy – the process



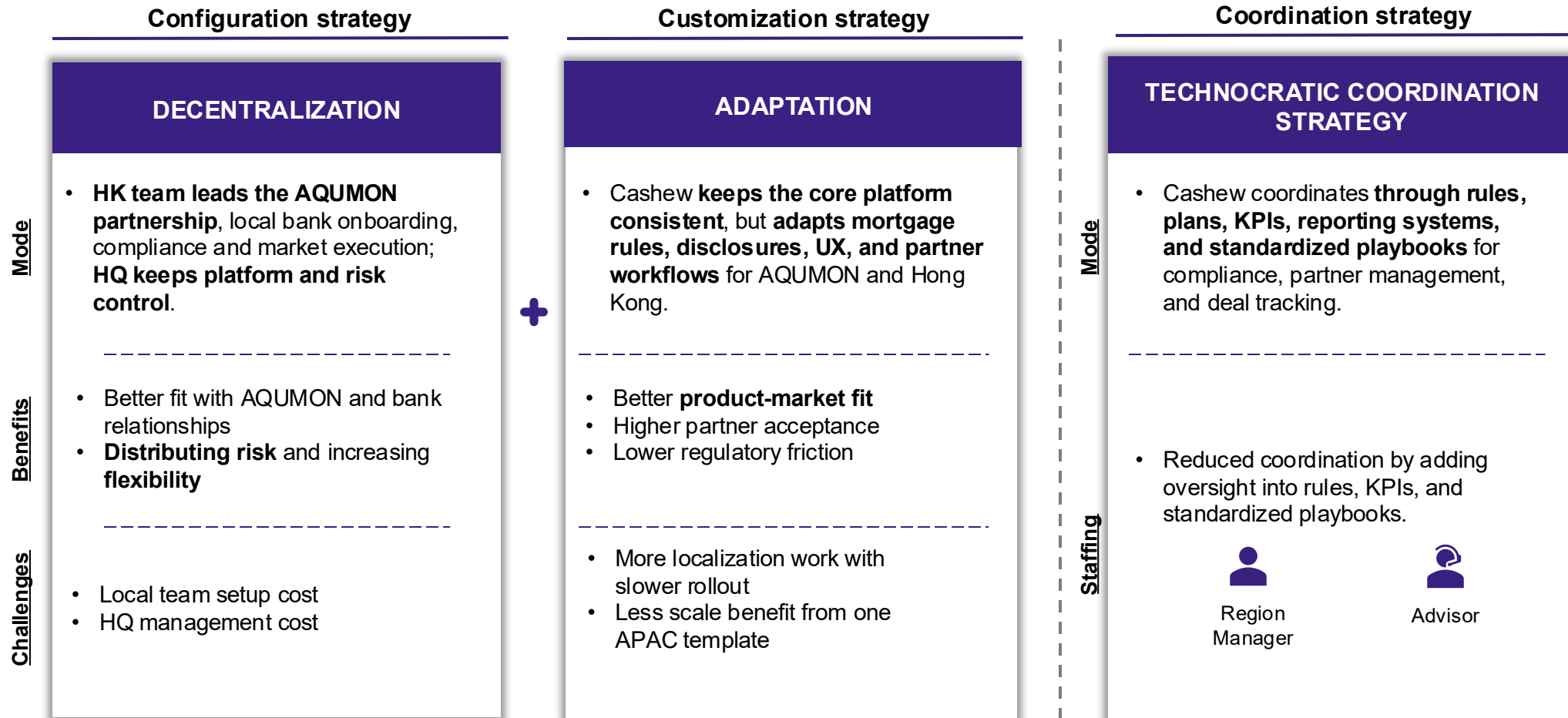
Cashew launches via AQUMON in six months, then scales or pivots based on conversion data

Go-to-market strategy – 3-year execution plan



A decentralized HK team with a localized platform is the lowest-friction path to market

Go-to-market strategy – allocation & coordination



A small orange house model with a grey roof and white window frames sits on a desk. In the foreground, a black pen with gold accents lies on a document. A calculator is also visible on the desk. The background is blurred, showing a green plant.

Thank you!

Q&A



Appendix

Appendix Agenda

01.

Cashew's business model

02.

Scoring methodology

03.

PESTEL framework and scores

04.

Relevant market data

05.

Competitors in Australia, Hong Kong and South Korea

06.

Porter's framework (Australia, Hong Kong and South Korea)

07.

Scoring methodology for market entry strategy

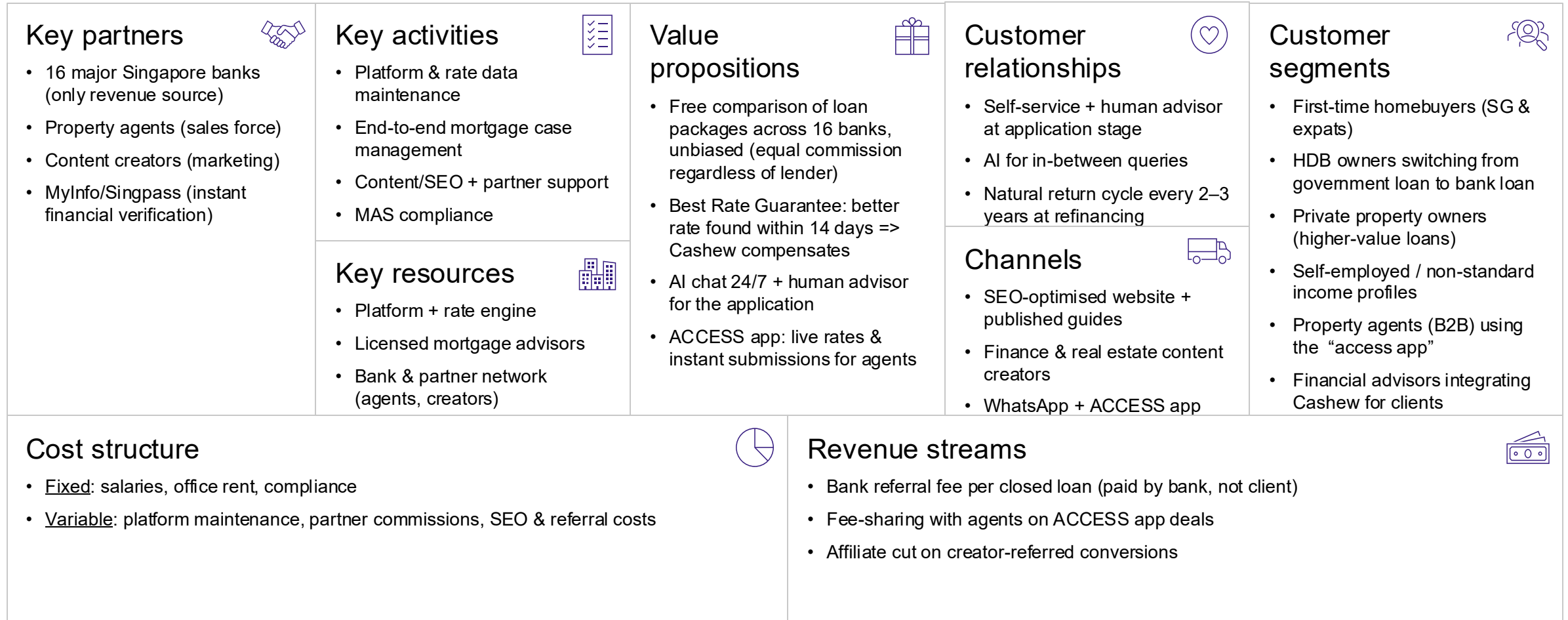
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OLI paradigm

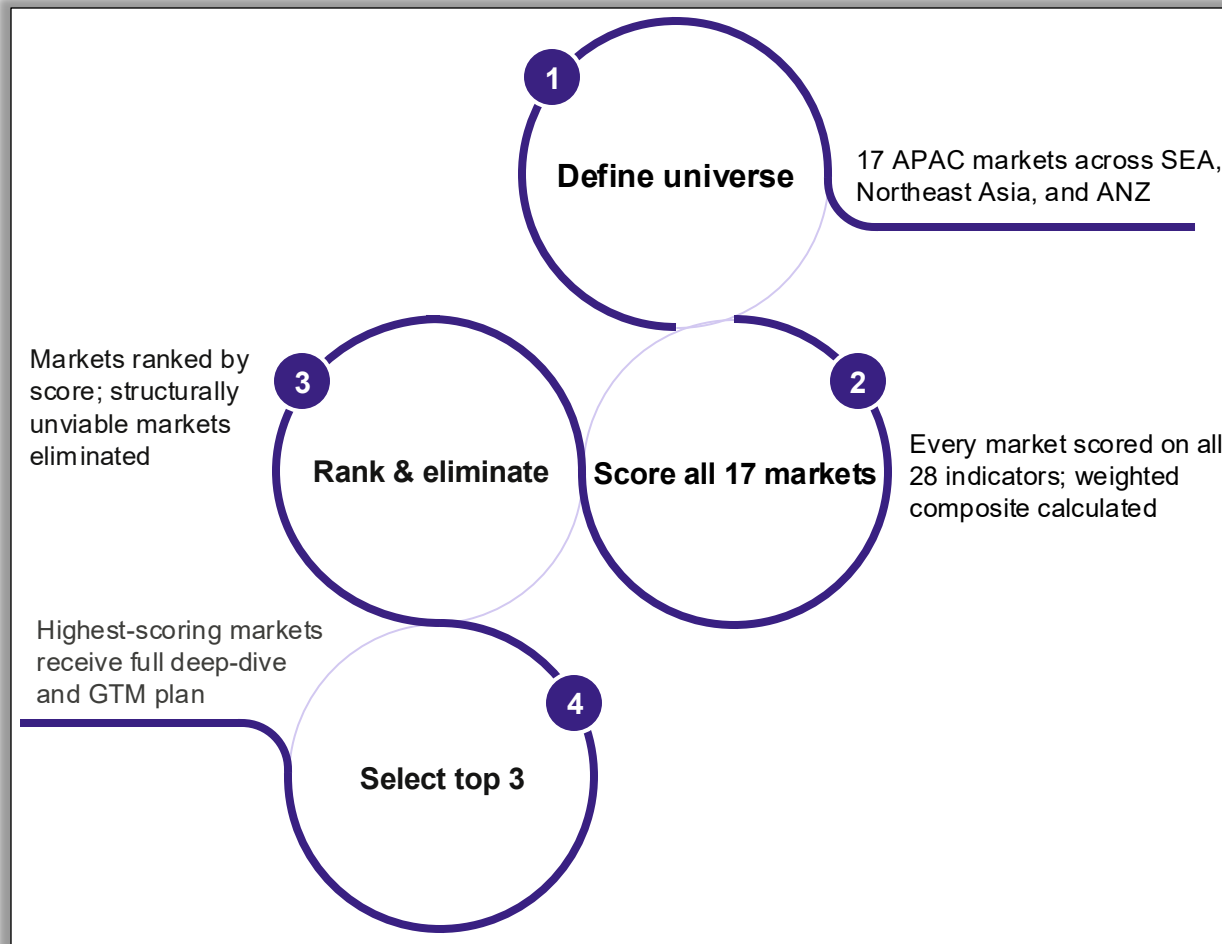
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Allocation & Coordination strategy

Cashew's business model



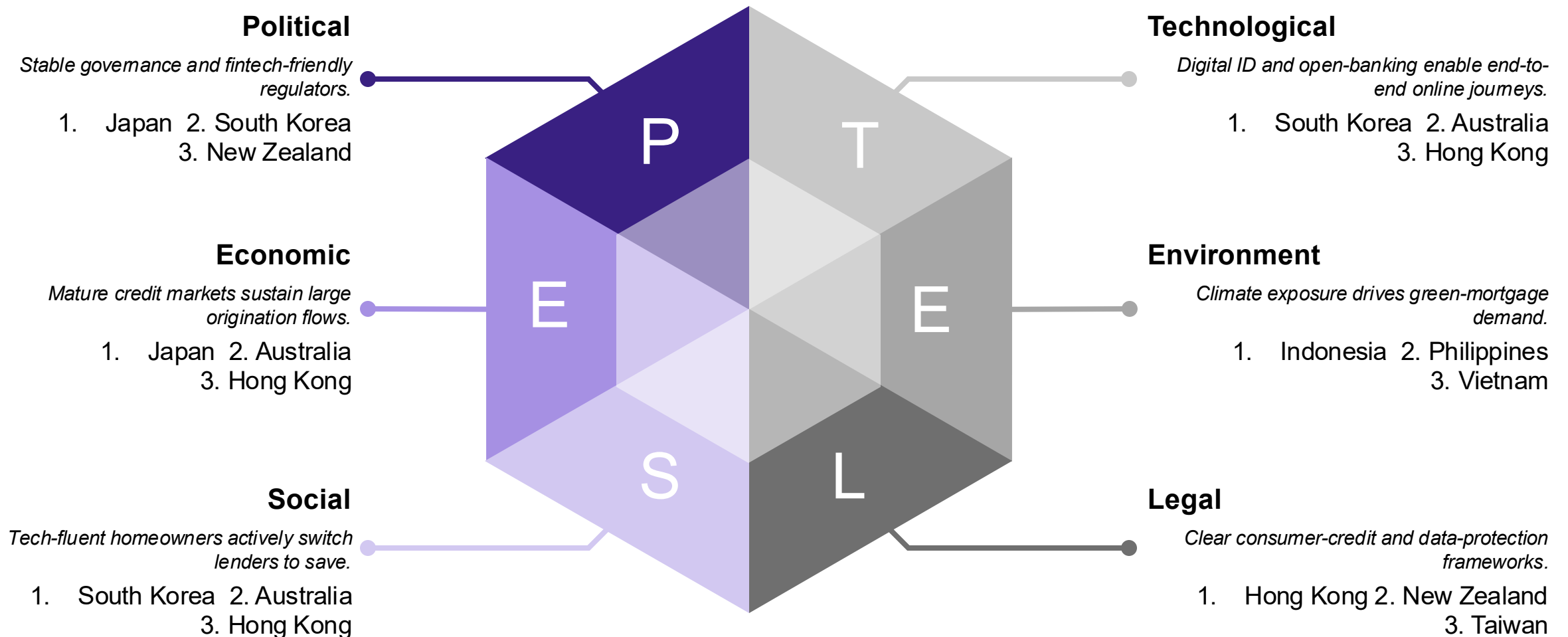
Score evaluation methodology



Macroenvironment 55%	
Political	10%
Economic	18%
Social	8%
Technological	4%
Environmental	5%
Legal	10%

Microenvironment 45%	
Market volume	20%
Market growth	10%
Competitors	5%
Procurement	5%
Cost situation	5%

Overview – Macro environment



Macro environment – Political

Market	Score	Description
Japan	0.47	Highest political score: stable, digitally advanced government, CPTPP partner with Singapore, and open to foreign property ownership
South Korea	0.44	OECD-grade openness, mature digital agenda, RCEP ties with Singapore, and unrestricted foreign property ownership
New Zealand	0.43	Top-tier stability and digital governance with CPTPP ties, pulled down only by very restrictive foreign property ownership rules
Australia	0.42	Stable democracy with a pro-fintech regulator and a digital economy agreement with Singapore; foreign property ownership is restricted
Hong Kong	0.40	HKMA actively courts foreign fintechs and runs a strong digital finance agenda; bilateral ties with Singapore are direct and well-established
Taiwan	0.40	FSC actively promotes fintech, strong digital roadmap, and an ASTEP agreement with Singapore
Malaysia	0.34	BNM has a clear fintech framework and strong CPTPP ties with Singapore, but political instability weighs on the score
Indonesia	0.32	OJK is fintech-friendly and BI's payment blueprint is ambitious, but political volatility and tight foreign property rules drag the score
Thailand	0.29	BoT supports fintech and digital roadmap is solid, but recurring political instability and restrictive property laws weigh on the score
Vietnam	0.28	SBV is cautiously building a fintech framework and CPTPP ties with Singapore are strong, but property restrictions and one-party governance drag the score
Philippines	0.27	Active BSP fintech program but persistent political instability and one of the most restrictive foreign property regimes

Macro environment – Economic

Market	Score	Description
Japan	0.84	• Highest real estate market and GDP, high GDP per capita, high household debt density
Australia	0.79	• Very high real estate market, very high GDP per capita, very high household debt density
Hong Kong	0.79	• Modest real estate market, very high GDP per capita, very high household debt density
South Korea	0.77	• Second highest real estate market, high GDP per capita, high household debt density
Taiwan	0.74	• Modest real estate market, high GDP per capita, high household debt density
Indonesia	0.61	• Third highest real estate market, very low GDP per capita, low household debt density
New Zealand	0.59	• Small real estate market, high GDP per capita, very high household debt density
Philippines	0.58	• Modest real estate market, very low GDP per capita, low household debt density
Malaysia	0.56	• Small real estate market, low GDP per capita, modest household debt density
Thailand	0.53	• Modest real estate market, very low GDP per capita, modest household debt density
Vietnam	0.39	• Modest real estate market, very low GDP per capita, low household debt density

Macro environment – Social

Market	Score	Description
Australia	0.37	Australia is one of the most digitally mature markets in APAC. Digital wallet use is strong, with 43% of POS payments and 21% of e-commerce payments made digitally, while online banking penetration reaches 69%
New Zealand	0.37	New Zealand is highly digital and has a strong property culture. Online banking penetration is 72.5%, and digital wallet use is already common
Hong Kong	0.345	Hong Kong is a very advanced digital hub, with 41% of POS payments and 45% of e-commerce payments made through digital wallets. It also has 51.9% online banking penetration
South Korea	0.34	South Korea is highly digital, with 82.1% online banking penetration and strong use of digital payments. high household debt, so mortgage comparison can be relevant, especially for refinancing
Taiwan	0.315	Taiwan has strong digital behavior, with 34% of POS payments and 36% of e-commerce payments made through digital wallets. Shows 43.9% monthly mobile payment usage, a good market for fintech adoption
Malaysia	0.30	Malaysia has solid digital adoption, with 26% of POS payments and 32% of e-commerce payments made digitally. The market is digitally accessible and relatively easy to localize
Philippines	0.28	The Philippines is a young and digital market, with 41% digital wallet use in POS, 29% in e-commerce, and 47.2% monthly mobile payment usage
Thailand	0.26	Thailand shows good digital adoption, especially in payments, with 63.2% real-time payments and 61.2% online banking penetration. Has potential, but it still needs full Thai localization
Indonesia	0.24	Indonesia has strong digital payment use, with 42% of POS payments made through digital wallets. Indonesia is still a medium-maturity market, so Bahasa localization and trust-building would be essential
Japan	0.225	Japan is a large market, but digital payment behavior is still more conservative, with only 29% digital wallet use in POS and 29% in e-commerce. Consumers remain more traditional than in other markets
Vietnam	0.22	Vietnam is a fast-growing digital market, with 38% digital wallet use in POS and 30% in e-commerce. Vietnam still has low mortgage-digitization maturity, but it has strong long-term potential

Macro environment – Technology

Market	Score	Description
South Korea	0.185	One of the most advanced digital ecosystems globally, with strong open banking and data infrastructure
Australia	0.183	The most mature and structured open banking market, ideal for full-scale digital mortgage integration
Hong Kong	0.175	A highly developed financial center with strong APIs and data transparency
New Zealand	0.167	Small but well-structured market with strong API standards and data transparency
Taiwan	0.160	A well-developed financial system with strong data quality, but slightly limited openness and integration compared to top-tier markets
Malaysia	0.152	The most balanced Southeast Asian market, offering solid infrastructure, relatively accessible data, and strong bank–fintech collaboration
Indonesia	0.149	A large, mobile-first market with strong payment infrastructure, but fragmented systems and uneven data availability increase execution complexity
Thailand	0.134	Strong digital payments and mobile usage, with open banking developing, but fragmented data limits full automation.
Japan	0.132	Market with strong technological infrastructure and a well-established banking system, but relatively lower fintech adoption and fragmented integration
Vietnam	0.112	Strong mobile adoption but still limited by underdeveloped financial infrastructure and standardization
Philippines	0.107	Rapidly growing digital usage with improving payment adoption, but infrastructure and data systems are still developing

Macro environment – Environmental

Market	Score	Description
Indonesia	0.25	Ringkas (\$5.1M pre-Series A) and IDEAL (seed stage) are the only direct analogs - both dramatically undercapitalised / Pinhome is proptech-first, mortgage is a feature / Cermati/Cekaja are O2O, not fully digital / Cashew enters as the most capitalised and digitally mature player from Day 1
Philippines	0.2	GCash (unicorn) has no mortgage comparison product – genuine first-mover gap / Maya (3M+ depositors) same dynamic — gap today, threat if they pivot / No dedicated digital mortgage comparison platform exists / Time-sensitive window before GCash extends its product suite
Vietnam	0.2	MoMo (\$300M+ raised, 31M users) has no mortgage comparison product - first-mover gap / Single-bank digital channels (Vietcombank, BIDV, Techcombank) cannot offer cross-bank comparison / No dedicated digital mortgage aggregator / Window closes if MoMo pivots into mortgage
Malaysia	0.15	RinggitPlus (\$27M, Experian-backed) + iMoney (2M+ monthly visits) are generalists – no mortgage-specialist depth / PropertyGuru Finance is the key threat – property search funnel / Partnership with PropertyGuru is preferred entry route / Clear niche for a mortgage-specialist digital player
Taiwan	0.15	MoneyHero (NASDAQ: MNY) is the only regional platform active in Taiwan — generalist, mortgage is one of many products / No mortgage-specialist digital broker identified / Clear niche open for Cashew's focused model
Thailand	0.15	Refinn is the only dedicated digital mortgage fintech – refinancing only, no new purchase coverage / KBank (20M+ digital users), SCB, Bangkok Bank are single-bank silos – structurally cannot offer cross-bank comparison / Full-journey digital mortgage comparison is unaddressed
South Korea	0.1	KakaoBank lends directly via Kakao super-app ecosystem – single-bank, cannot offer neutral comparison / Toss (fintech unicorn) is a latent competitive threat in any consumer finance segment / Trust moat built on Kakao relationship is enormous and hard to overcome
Australia	0.1	Lendi Group (ASX-listed parent) is near-identical to Cashew's model with 10-year head start / Mortgage Choice (REA Group) adds further dominance / Athena (\$120M+ raised) and Tiimely (\$25M) compete for same digital-savvy borrower from the lending side / Saturated market
Hong Kong	0.1	mReferral has processed HKD 1.27T, serves 430K+ customers / 25-year institutional relationships create a bank access moat that took decades to build / MoneyHero (NASDAQ) adds generalist competition / Cashew UX would be superior but distribution moat is very hard to break
New Zealand / Brunei / Cambodia / Laos / Myanmar / Timor-Leste / Vietnam	0.05	New Zealand: Squirrel (\$3B/yr origination, 15yr head start) is the NZ Cashew — same model, already entrenched in a market too small to justify standalone entry / Frontier SEA (Brunei, Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar, Timor-Leste): formal mortgage markets are minimal or absent — banking infrastructure is pre-digital / Not applicable for Cashew's model

Macro environment – Legal

Market	Score	Description
Hong Kong	0.43	• HKMA Banking Supervisory Framework/Estate Agents Ordinance/Land Registration Ordinance/Stamp Duty Ordinance
New Zealand	0.31	• FSLAA 2019 / FAP Licence Regime(FMCA 2013)/Credit Contracts and Consumer Finance Act 2003 (CCCFA)/RBNZ LVR/DTI Restrictions (BS19)/Anti-Money Laundering and Countering Financing of Terrorism Act 2009 (AML/CFT Act)
Taiwan	0.31	• Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA) – 2025 Amendments/Banking Association TSP Rules/Outsourcing Regulations/ISO 27001
Malaysia	0.28	• BNM Policy Document on Outsourcing (2023)/Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA) 2010/PDPA Amendments (2024)/Securities Commission (SC) P2P Registration (referenced by analogy)/Moneylenders Act (licensing requirement)
Australia	0.25	• National Consumer Credit Protection Act 2009 (NCCP Act); Anti-Money Laundering and Counter-Terrorism Financing Act 2006 (AML/CTF Act)/APRA APG 223 Residential Mortgage Lending/FIRB Foreign Investment Rules
Japan	0.21	• Financial Service Intermediary Act/Banking Act/Act on the Protection of Personal Information (APPI)
Indonesia	0.21	• POJK 4/2025 (OJK/FSA Provider Licensing Regulation)/UU PDP (Personal Data Protection Law)/Local entity (PT PMA) and capital requirements
Thailand	0.21	• Bank of Thailand (BOT) Market Conduct Guidelines/BOT Outsourcing Regulations/Personal Data Protection Act (PDPA B.E. 2562)/Foreign ownership and licensing restrictions
South Korea	0.19	• Credit Information Act/Financial Consumer Protection Act/FSC Online Loan Platform Framework
Vietnam	0.14	• Fintech Regulatory Sandbox Framework (sandbox-first approach) /PDPD Decree (13/2023)/E-Transactions Law (2023)/Ministry of Public Security (MPS) approval requirements/Data localization requirements/State Bank of Vietnam (SBV) notification requirements/P2P lending sandbox restrictions (including foreign investment limitations)
Philippines	0.11	• SEC ban on new OLP registrations, BSP outsourcing/cyber rules, Data Privacy Act, and cross-border data transfer restrictions

Micro environment – Economic

Market	Score	Description
Australia	1.5	• Second highest total loans volume, mostly household debt and very high real estate growth expectations
South Korea	1.4	• Third highest volumes, entirely composed by household debt, combined with solid growth prospects
Japan	1.3	• Highest loans and household debt market, but slower expected real estate growth
Malaysia	1.2	• Modest loans volumes, with high real estate growth expectations
Taiwan	1.1	• Total loans composed entirely by household debt, consistent real estate growth expectations
Thailand	1.1	• Modest loans volumes, with solid real estate growth projections
Hong Kong	1	• High total loans volumes, small portion is household debt, negative real estate growth expectations
Indonesia	0.9	• Smaller loans volumes, but big real estate and modest growth expectations
New Zealand	0.9	• Smaller loans volumes, with modest real estate and consistent growth expectations
Philippines	0.8	• Small loans volumes, with modest real estate volumes and growth expectations
Brunei	0.7	• Very small loans volumes, with small real estate but high expected growth

Micro environment – Competitors

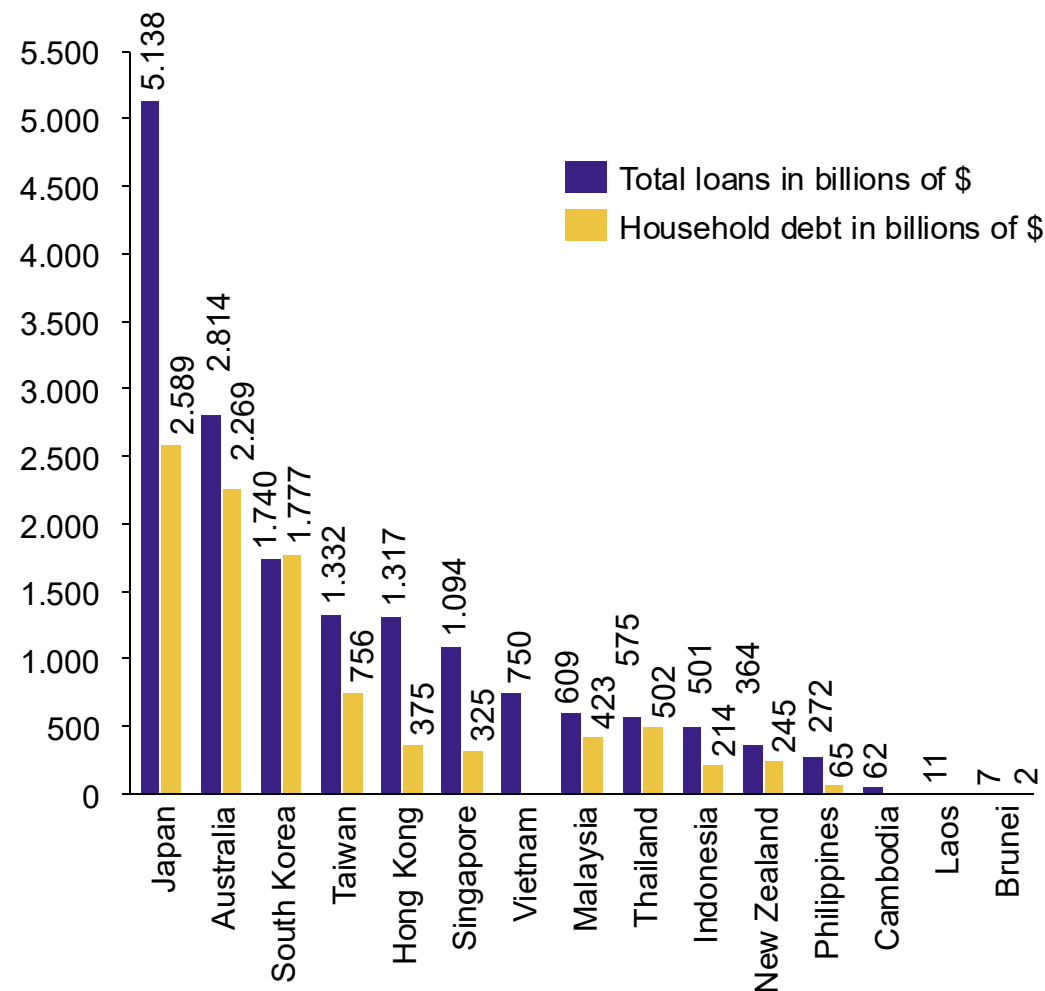
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Hong Kong	0.1	mReferral has processed HKD 1.27T, serves 430K+ customers / 25-year institutional relationships create a bank access moat that took decades to build / MoneyHero (NASDAQ) adds generalist competition / Cashew UX would be superior but distribution moat is very hard to break
New Zealand / Brunei / Cambodia / Laos / Myanmar / Timor-Leste / Vietnam	0.05	New Zealand: Squirrel (\$3B/yr origination, 15yr head start) is the NZ Cashew — same model, already entrenched in a market too small to justify standalone entry / Frontier SEA (Brunei, Cambodia, Laos, Myanmar, Timor-Leste): formal mortgage markets are minimal or absent — banking infrastructure is pre-digital / Not applicable for Cashew's model

Micro environment – Cost situation

Market	Score	Description
Vietnam	0.2	• Low acquisition and operational costs
Malaysia	0.2	• Good balance between acquisition and operations makes the market relatively low-cost and efficient
Indonesia	0.15	• A low-cost but complex market due to scale and fragmentation
Thailand	0.15	• Moderate acquisition costs and manageable operations lets the market become cost-efficient
Philippines	0.15	• A relatively low-cost market with growing efficiency but some execution challenges
Hong Kong	0.15	• The cost is relatively high which is driven by expensive acquisition and operational expenses
New Zealand	0.15	• A moderate-cost market with relatively efficient operations
Taiwan	0.15	• The cost is balanced with moderate acquisition and operational expenses
Australia	0.1	• Cost is high due to strong competition and expensive customer acquisition, making scalability costly
South Korea	0.1	• Strong local competition and high entry barriers
Japan	0.1	• Low conversion efficiency and high localization effort lead to high cost

Total loans and household debt

Country	Total loans	Household debt	Household debt as % of GDP
Japan	5,138 \$bn	2,589 \$bn	61.20%
Australia	2,814 \$bn	2,269 \$bn	120.30%
South Korea	1,740 \$bn	1,777 \$bn	91.70%
Taiwan ²	1,332 \$bn	756 \$bn	94.30%
Hong Kong ³	1,317 \$bn	375 \$bn	87.60%
Singapore ³	1,094 \$bn	325 \$bn	51.60%
Vietnam	750 \$bn	n/a	n/a
Malaysia	609 \$bn	423 \$bn	84.80%
Thailand	575 \$bn	502 \$bn	86.70%
Indonesia ³	501 \$bn	214 \$bn	15%
New Zealand ³	364 \$bn	245 \$bn	91.10%
Philippines	272 \$bn	65 \$bn	13.60%
Cambodia ^{2,3}	62 \$bn	13 \$bn	27.20%
Laos ¹	11 \$bn	n/a	n/a
Brunei ¹	7 \$bn	2 \$bn	15.40%
Myanmar	n/a	n/a	n/a
Timor-Leste	n/a	n/a	n/a



Real estate market volume

Country	Total RE market (2025)	Residential RE market (2025)	CAGR 2026–2031
Japan	26,336.00 \$bn	14,280.00 \$bn	+1.57%
South Korea	12,143.30 \$bn	8,100.00 \$bn	+1.90%
Indonesia	8,790.50 \$bn	7,590.00 \$bn	+0.94%
Australia	8,105.90 \$bn	6,410.00 \$bn	+4.04%
Philippines	6,302.00 \$bn	5,490.00 \$bn	+1.99%
Taiwan	4,462.90 \$bn	3,310.00 \$bn	+0.27%
Vietnam	4,357.10 \$bn	3,850.00 \$bn	+3.00%
Hong Kong	3,790.00 \$bn	3,030.00 \$bn	-0.85%
Thailand	2,521.40 \$bn	2,170.00 \$bn	+2.28%
Singapore	2,029.50 \$bn	1,520.00 \$bn	+2.44%
New Zealand	837.70 \$bn	603.01 \$bn	+1.67%
Malaysia	823.00 \$bn	641.67 \$bn	+3.43%
Myanmar	745.20 \$bn	650.33 \$bn	+2.26%
Cambodia	577.20 \$bn	530.19 \$bn	+1.77%
Laos*	100.40 \$bn	86.11 \$bn	+2.18%
Brunei	25.20 \$bn	14.15 \$bn	+4.58%
Timor-Leste	21.70 \$bn	18.79 \$bn	+2.81%

GDP, GDP per capita and population density

Country	GDP	GDP per capita	Population density	Household debt density (Household debt / population)
Japan	4,435 \$bn	35,973 \$	338	21
South Korea	1,872 \$bn	36,227 \$	531	34
Australia	1,840 \$bn	66,352 \$	4	84
Indonesia	1,446 \$bn	5,082 \$	158	1
Taiwan	920 \$bn	39,489 \$	653	33
Singapore	604 \$bn	99,365 \$	8,387	55
Thailand	577 \$bn	8,057 \$	140	7
Vietnam	494 \$bn	4,829 \$	328	
Philippines	487 \$bn	4,270 \$	392	1
Malaysia	472 \$bn	13,949 \$	110	12
Hong Kong	427 \$bn	56,893 \$	7,044	51
New Zealand	259 \$bn	48,621 \$	20	47
Myanmar	82 \$bn	1,502 \$	84	
Cambodia	49 \$bn	2,762 \$	101	1
Laos	18 \$bn	2,288 \$	34	
Brunei	16 \$bn	34,678 \$	88	5
Timor-Leste	2 \$bn	1,464 \$	95	

Online banking penetration: Statista (2025). | Household debt: CEIC (2025) — % of GDP × GDP. | * No data available (searched CEIC + World Bank). | Singapore excluded (home market). | Sorted by online banking penetration descending.

Competitors – Australia

Opportunity: LOW → Fully digital players already well-established

Company	Type	Size	Scale / Funding	vs Cashew	Porter strategy
Lendi (Lendi Group)	Digital mortgage platform	Large	ASX-listed parent; >\$80B loan book; 1,300+ brokers; merged with Aussie 2021	Near-identical model to Cashew, digital comparison + advisor network. Direct, well-funded rival with a 10-yr head start.	Differentiation
Aussie Home Loans	Broker franchise (Lendi Group)	Large	REA Group / Lendi Group; 230+ stores nationally; est. 1992	Physical + digital hybrid. Outpaces Cashew by ~100x. Brand is a dominant moat.	Differentiation
Mortgage Choice	Franchise broker network	Large	REA Group; nationwide since 1992	Traditional franchise, less digitally native. Cashew would have UX edge, but brand gap is enormous.	Differentiation
Tiimely Home (ex Tic:Toc)	Fully digital direct lender	Mid	~\$25M raised; Bendigo Bank partnership	Lends directly — does not broker. Competes for the same digitally-savvy buyer but different revenue model.	Cost Leadership
Athena Home Loans	Digital direct lender	Large	~\$120M+ raised; backed by WestPac, AustralianSuper	Lender not broker. No comparison angle. Very well-capitalised direct competitor for digital mortgage origination.	Cost Leadership

Competitors – Hong Kong

Opportunity: MEDIUM → mReferral is a 25yr incumbent but the regulation is very fintech-forward (CDI data, virtual banks)

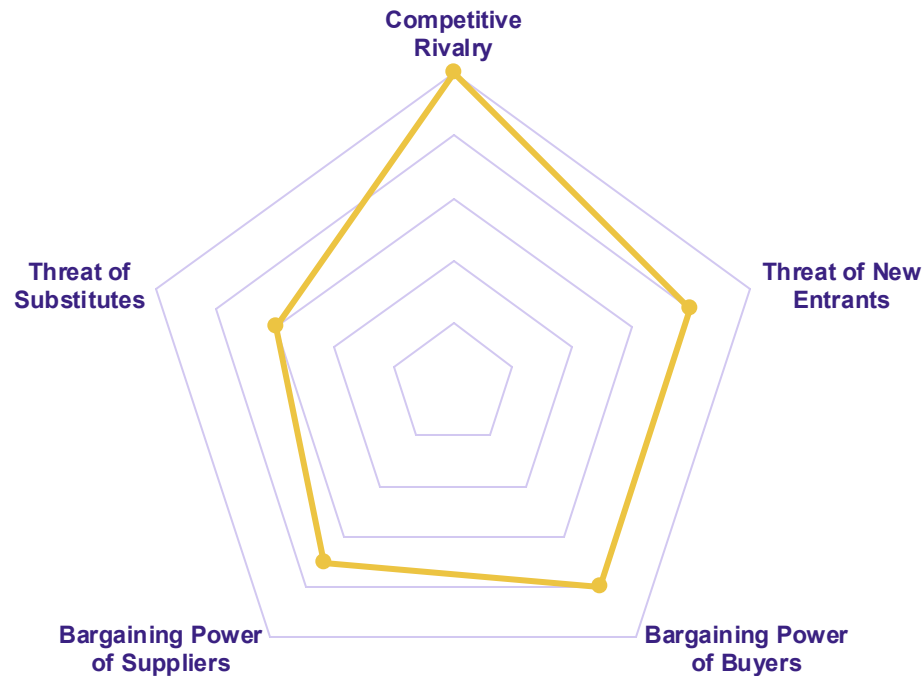
Company	Type	Size	Scale / Funding	vs Cashew	Porter strategy
mReferral (Meridian Mortgage Referral)	Mortgage comparison + referral	Large	JV: CK Hutchison + Midland Holdings; 430K+ customers; HKD 1.27T processed; 70+ bank partners; est. 2000	The dominant incumbent. Relationship-heavy and 25yr old brand. Digitally stale — Cashew's UX would be objectively better, but bank access moat is very hard to break.	Differentiation
MoneyHero (HK)	Multi-product financial comparison platform	Large	NASDAQ-listed (MNY); active in HK, SG, TW, PH; licensed insurance broker	Mortgage is one of many products — no specialist depth. Cashew's mortgage focus is the differentiator.	Differentiation
28 Mortgage / Starpro Agency	Boutique mortgage brokers	Small	Small independent brokers; no tech platform	Traditional, no technology. Cashew outcompetes easily on digital experience but these are relationship-based.	Focus

Competitors – South Korea

Opportunity: MEDIUM → KakaoBank is a dominant digital lender

Company	Type	Size	vs Cashew	Porter strategy
KakaoBank	Digital bank with direct mortgage origination	Large	Lends directly — does not broker. Single-bank product. Cashew's multi-bank comparison is the differentiator but KakaoBank's trust moat is enormous.	Cost Leadership

Porter's 5 forces framework – Australia



Competitive Rivalry — Very High

- Established fintechs like Lendi and Athena, plus aggregators and incumbents, compete aggressively on rates, UX, and distribution scale.

Threat of New Entrants — High

- Entry barriers are moderate: capital needs are not huge, but licensing, AUSTRAC registration, and CDR accreditation still create friction.

Bargaining Power of Buyers — High

- Borrowers are highly price-sensitive, switching costs are low, and CDR makes comparison and switching easier.

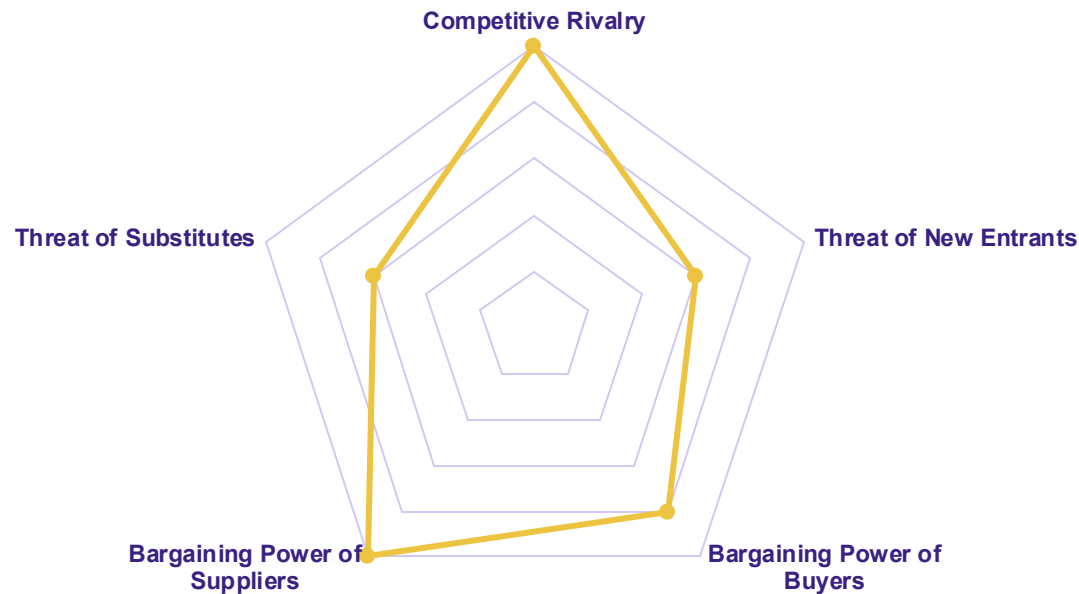
Bargaining Power of Suppliers — Mod-High

- Big Four banks and aggregators control access to much of the market, although CDR partially reduces that dependence.

Threat of Substitutes — Moderate

- Direct bank channels, neobanks, and emerging digital tools can partially replace broker platforms.

Porter's 5 forces framework – Hong Kong



Competitive Rivalry — Very High

- Banks, property agents, and comparison platforms compete for the same borrowers.

Threat of New Entrants — Moderate

- Regulatory requirements and distribution access create barriers, even if the technical setup is manageable.

Bargaining Power of Buyers — High

- Borrowers can compare easily and switch quickly, especially in refinancing.

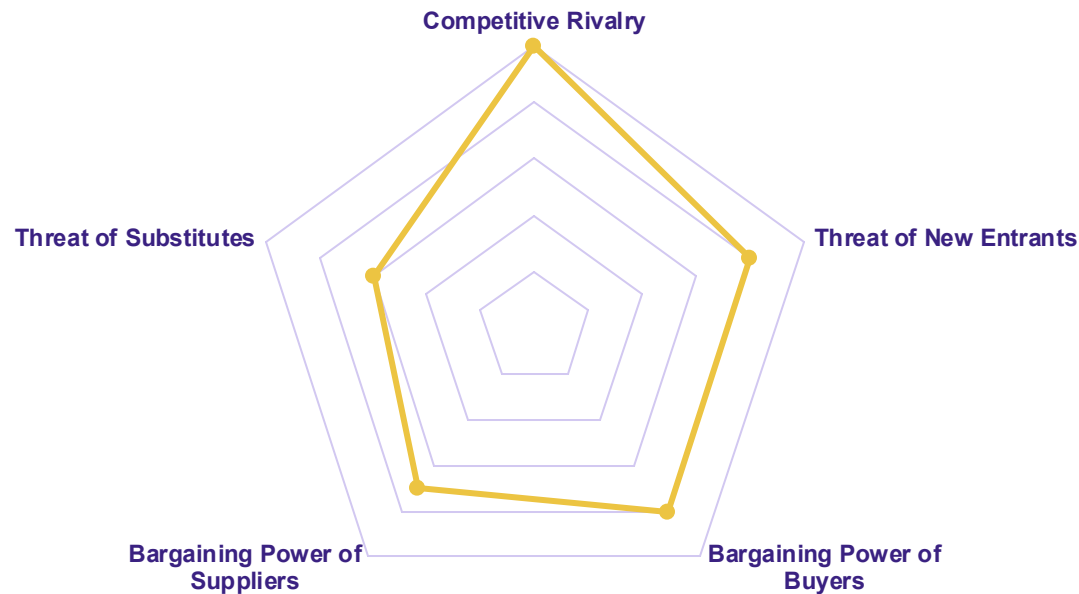
Bargaining Power of Suppliers — Very High

- A small number of banks control pricing and approvals, so platform dependence remains high.

Threat of Substitutes — Very High

- Direct bank channels and property agents are the main alternatives, especially for complex borrowers.

Porter's 5 forces framework – South Korea



Competitive Rivalry — Medium-High

- No multi-bank comparison platform exists yet, but KakaoBank and Toss Bank already dominate digital lending.

Threat of New Entrants — Medium

- Entry is feasible, but local incorporation, licensing, and full localization still create meaningful barriers.

Bargaining Power of Buyers — High

- Consumers are digitally active, price-sensitive, and can switch quickly if a better rate appears.

Bargaining Power of Suppliers — Medium

- A few banking groups control most of the market, though open banking is gradually reducing their advantage.

Scoring methodology for market entry strategy

Dimension	Weight	Low (1)	Medium (2)	High (3)
Impact Revenue & strategic upside	40%	Revenue capped by structure (fees only), no brand building, no equity upside in HK	Moderate market presence, partial value capture, limited long-term positioning	Full market presence, equity upside, brand building under Cashew's name, path to wholly-owned subsidiary
Feasibility Execution readiness	35%	Requires new legal entity, HKMA licensing, partner negotiation >9 months, high capital outlay	Moderate complexity, partner-dependent, 6–9 months to structure, limited capital required	No new entity, partner already licensed, minimal capital, fastest to implement
Risk Downside exposure	25%	High IP leakage risk or high capital exposure, difficult to reverse	Moderate exposure, contractual protection only, partner misalignment possible	Risk shared with partner, buy-out clause limits dependency, financially reversible

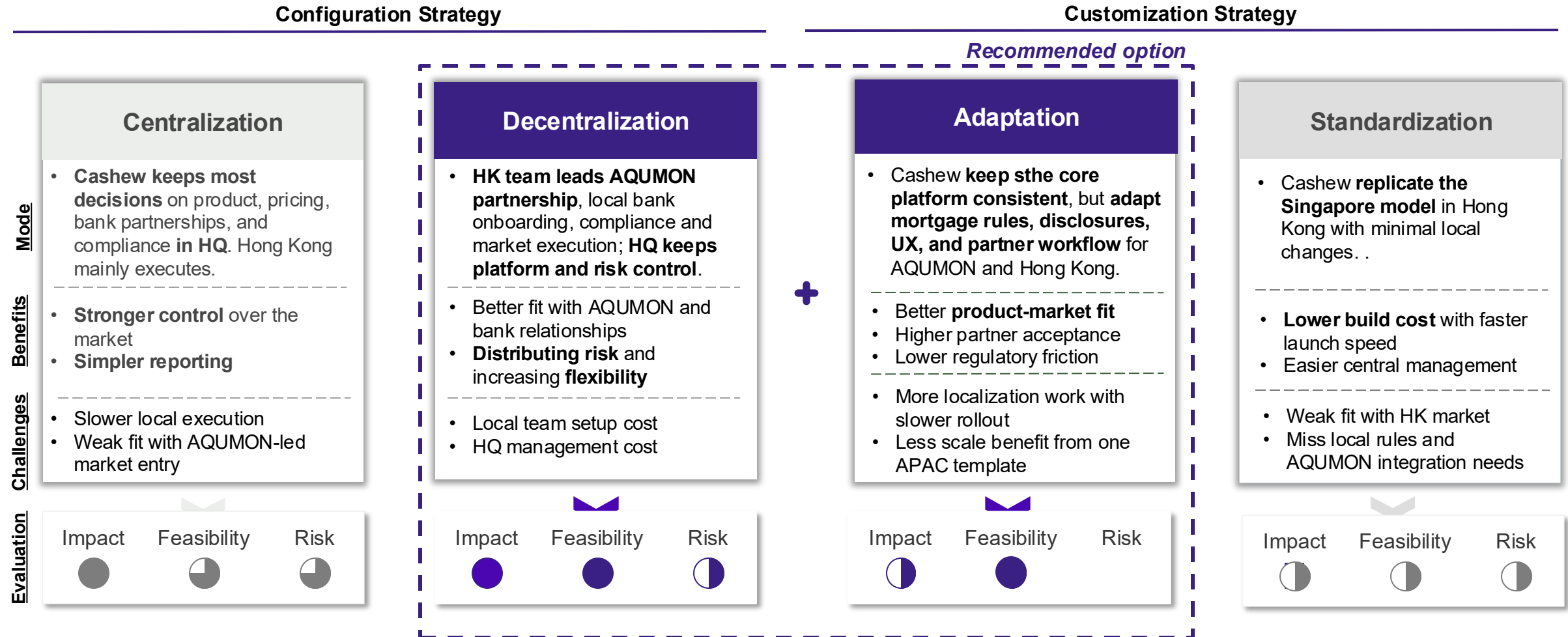
WEIGHTED SCORES BY OPTION

Dimension	Option A Licensing	Option B Strategic alliance	Option C Joint venture	
Impact (×0.40)	Low – 1	Medium/High – 3	High – 4	Licensing scores 1: revenue capped at licensing fees, no brand building, Cashew becomes a technology vendor with no market presence. Strategic Alliance: Cashew retains full product control and advisor relationship, capturing meaningful value while building HK presence. JV: full market presence, equity upside, and a built-in path to a wholly-owned subsidiary.
Feasibility (×0.35)	High – 4	Medium/High – 3	Medium/Low – 2	Licensing scores 4: no new entity, no license, minimal capital, fastest to implement. Strategic Alliance scores 3: lighter than a JV but finding an aligned partner in a market where Cashew has no presence is non-trivial. JV scores 2: partner negotiation, equity structuring, and HK incorporation add 6–9 months of lead time.
Risk (×0.25) 1 – High 4 – Low	Low – 4	Medium/Low – 3	High – 1	Licensing scores 4: no capital exposure. Strategic Alliance scores 3: low financial exposure, contractual protection limits downside, and the agreement is easy to exit or renegotiate. JV scores 1: high capital commitment, partner misalignment risk, and equity structuring makes it difficult to reverse.
Weighted score	2.8	3.00	2.55	

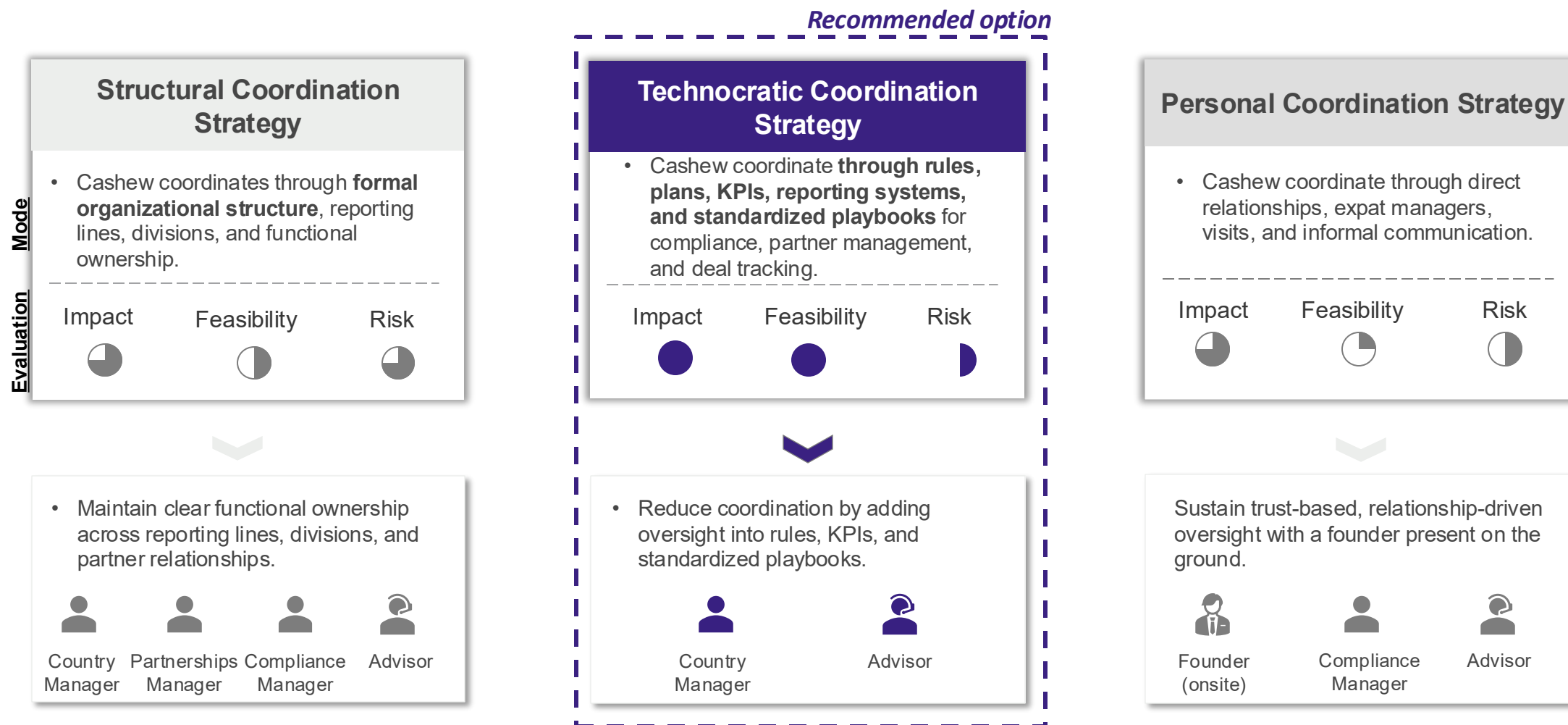
OLI paradigm – Hong Kong

Dimension	Cashew's position	Implication
O – Ownership Does Cashew have ownership advantages that support foreign expansion?	YES – strong - Proprietary mortgage comparison engine built for SG market - Digital application flow (replaces calls + paperwork) - Advisor network model already validated - Singapore regulatory playbook transferable to HK - Brand as first digital-native mortgage platform in origin market	- Cashew has something worth taking abroad — the technology and model are the ownership advantage - These are intangible assets (know-how, UX, process) → for Dunning, intangible ownership advantages are most suited to international transfer
L – Location Does HK offer advantages that justify operating there vs. from SG?	YES – meaningful - HK mortgage market: ~HK\$1.7T outstanding, falling rates → refinancing wave 93% of HK investors use digital wealth services — higher than SG - No dominant digital mortgage comparison player (MoneyHero is partial) - Mass affluent segment: 4.2M people, direct Cashew target - Common language (English + Cantonese), similar legal system to SG	- Location advantages exist → internationalisation is justified - BUT: Cashew lacks local bank relationships, local brand, local regulatory knowledge → cannot fully exploit location advantages alone - This is why a local partner (AQUMON) is needed to unlock the location advantage
I – Internalization Should Cashew keep activities in-house or rely on the market?	Partial – not yet - Bank API integrations in HK: too costly to build alone from scratch - Demand uncertainty: HK volume unvalidated → FDI premature - Regulatory approval process for new bank channels: 6–12 months even with relationships - Brand awareness in HK: zero — customer acquisition cost would be very high standalone	- Internalization advantages are weak at this stage → FDI not optimal - Better to externalise distribution to AQUMON via contract (non-equity alliance) and retain control only over product and advisors - As market matures and volume is validated → internalization increases → can move toward FDI in Phase 2–3

Allocation strategy – comparison



Coordination strategy – comparison



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